INDIA TODAY ENERGY SUMMIT

THE GREEN POWER SHIFT

FROM FOSSIL FUELS TO SOLAR CELLS, INDIA'S ENERGY REVOLUTION IS ELECTRIFYING. BUT CAN IT SUSTAIN THE CURRENT MOMENTUM? POLICYMAKERS, INDUSTRY LEADERS AND EXPERTS SHARE THEIR VISION AND CONCERNS

BY ANILESH S. MAHAJAN

As part of its ambitious green goals, India aims to reduce the emissions intensity of its GDP by 45 per cent from the levels in 2005 and achieve 50 per cent of its electricity generation from non-fossil fuels by 2030 in its overall journey towards net-zero in the long run. Tracking progress and troubleshooting challenges were top stakeholders from the Union government—cabinet ministers Nitin Gadkari and Pralhad Joshi along with renewable energy secretary Bhupinder Bhalla—who joined forces with 20 energy CEOs and eight experts at the high-voltage India Today Energy Summit 2024 on September 6. Highlighting the delicate balance between traditional power sources and the surge of renewables, the summit participants also took note of crucial enablers like grid upgrades and regional connectivity. As the world's third-largest oil consumer, India faces a unique challenge: reducing energy imports while ramping up domestic production and simultaneously pivoting to cleaner alternatives like solar and wind energy. The road to 500 GW of renewable capacity by 2030 is paved with hurdles—from land acquisition to financing and storage technologies. Discoms, the often-overlooked linchpins of the energy sector, took centre stage as experts prescribed much-needed reforms to boost efficiency and attract investment. The summit served as a crystal ball, offering glimpses of a dynamic energy future driven by policy reforms, innovation, regional collaboration and infrastructure augmentation. ■

▼ RENEWABLE



Pralhad Joshi, *Union Minister of New & Renewable*

▼ FIRESIDE

TAKEAWAYS

The government targets 30% private cars, 70% commercial vehicles, 40% buses and 80% two- and three-wheelers to be EVs by 2030

Electric buses are cheaper to run, with a cost of Rs 39 per km compared to Rs 60 for diesel buses, driving their adoption in cities like Mumbai

EV prices are falling due to increased demand and production, especially as lithium-ion battery costs drop, eliminating the need for subsidies



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR